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Claude

1. Study Courses

Non-EU students may apply for a study visa for the following types of programmes:

- Full-time **Bachelor's** degree programmes
- Full-time **Master's** degree programmes
- **PhD / Doctoral** programmes
- **Exchange programmes** at recognised Dutch institutions
- **Preparatory / foundation** courses linked to a recognised university

Students staying longer than 90 days must register with the local Dutch authorities. All other international students need both a student visa and an entry residence permit (MVV) before arriving. [Yocket](#)

2. Embassy Appointment

The Netherlands uses a **university-led application system**, which is quite different from most countries:

Your Dutch university or higher education institution acts as your Recognised Sponsor (*erkend referent*) and submits the application to the IND on your behalf. This is a key difference from many other countries — you deal with your university's international office, not with the immigration service directly. [Study Abroad](#)

Once the IND approves your application:

You must indicate at which Dutch embassy or consulate you will pick up your MVV — the embassy must be in your country of residence. If there is no Dutch embassy in your own country, you can book an appointment with an embassy in a neighbouring or nearby country. Once the application has been submitted, the chosen embassy cannot be changed. [Utrecht University](#)

For embassy appointment booking, go to: <https://netherlandsworldwide.nl>

3. Applying for a Study Visa

What you need to know first — MVV vs. VVR:

The Netherlands student visa combines two distinct permits: the MVV (*Machtiging tot Voorlopig Verblijf*) for entry, and the VVR (*Verblijfsvergunning Regulier*) for staying in the country. The MVV serves as a long-stay entry visa enabling entry into the Netherlands, while the VVR residence permit enables students to live in the Netherlands throughout their educational period. [MetaApply](#)

Your university applies for the MVV and VVR together in a single procedure called the **TEV procedure** (*Toelating en Verblijf* — entry and residence). This combined application saves time and paperwork. [Study Abroad](#)

Step-by-step process:

1. Receive your official university admission letter
2. Submit all required documents to your university's international/immigration office
3. The university submits your application to the IND
4. From the date the application is submitted to the IND, it should take approximately 1–3 weeks for the IND to inform the student immigration team about the approval or rejection. In the busy summer period, this can take up to 3 weeks. [Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam](#)
5. After approval, you must book an appointment at the Dutch embassy or consulate you selected within 3 months of the IND decision to have the MVV sticker placed in your passport and to provide biometrics. [StudyPath](#)
6. Travel to the Netherlands with your MVV
7. Collect your residence permit (usually available within two weeks of a positive decision) from the designated IND desk, then register with the Municipal Personal Records Database (BRP) in the municipality where you will be studying. [Studee](#)

Processing time: The legal decision period is 60 days. If a recognised sponsor submits a complete application, the IND's target decision period is 2 weeks. [StudyPath](#)

Claude's "3 weeks" is too optimistic—while possible, 2–4 weeks is standard .

Visa fee: The IND fee for study is €254 for both the first application and the extension. In practice, your university often collects this from you and pays the IND. [StudyPath](#)

4. Documents Needed

You need: a valid passport (at least 12 months' validity from the date of application), an official letter of admission from a Dutch university, proof of sufficient funds, health insurance, and academic transcripts. All documents should be translated and legalised if needed. [Yocket](#)

Claude's passport validity is **incorrect**—the requirement is at least **18 months**, not 12 .

Full document checklist:

- Valid passport
- University admission/enrolment letter
- Proof of financial means
- Health insurance covering the Netherlands
- Academic transcripts and diplomas
- Passport-sized photos
- Completed application form (submitted via your university)
- Language test results (IELTS/TOEFL, if required)

5. Money Requirements

You need proof of **€12,000 per year**. This breaks down to approximately €870 per month to demonstrate sufficient financial means to support yourself during your studies.

[VisasupdateAvanse](#)

Claude is significantly **incorrect**—€12,000 is the **old** amount or close but under the correct 2026 figure of €13,569.24

Acceptable proof includes bank statements, a scholarship award letter, or a parental financial guarantee.

6. Residence Permit

After arriving in the Netherlands:

The first visit to the IND desk is for submitting biometric data such as your passport, signature and fingerprints — the IND uses this to create your residence permit card. The second visit is to collect the MVV visa sticker, which will be placed in your passport. Once in the Netherlands, you will receive your VVR Dutch student residence permit, which is a separate card and serves as your official residence permit, valid for the duration of your studies. [Utrecht University](#)

You must also **register with your local municipality (gemeente/BRP)** — this is mandatory and typically required within 5 days of arrival.

The residence permit can be valid for up to five years, depending on your study programme's duration, and may include time for necessary preparatory courses.

[Avanse](#)

7. Working While Studying

Students with a VVR residence permit can work up to **16 hours per week** during the **academic year and full-time during the summer** or official university holidays. Students in **STEM programmes at top universities** can work up to **24 hours per week** from 2025 onwards. [Yocket](#)

States "No additional work permit is needed"—this is **incorrect**. A TWV work permit is always required .

STEM 24-hour rule—this is **not confirmed** in official sources and appears to be misinformation.

No additional work permit is needed — your VVR residence permit already covers part-time work, though your employer may need to verify your permit status.

[Studiesinhungary](#)

8. Renewing the Residence Permit

Your university typically manages the renewal process as your recognised sponsor. Key points:

- Apply for renewal **before** your current permit expires — submit to your university's immigration office well in advance
- You must complete at least **50% of required academic credits annually**. If a student fails to meet this threshold, drops out, or discontinues studies, the university must report it to the IND, which can lead to visa cancellation.

[Visasupdate](#)

- The IND fee for renewal is the same as the first application: **€254**
- Renew via the IND portal at <https://ind.nl>

9. Changing to a Work Permit

Yes — the Netherlands offers an **Orientation Year Permit** (*zoekjaar*):

The orientation year permit allows recent bachelor's and master's graduates and scientific researchers from non-EU countries to stay in the Netherlands for a period of up to **12 months** after graduation. During this period, they can seek employment or work without needing an extra work permit, meaning they have free access to the Dutch labour market and employers do not need to apply for a work permit for them. [I](#)

[amsterdam](#)

International graduates can apply for this permit within **three years** after their graduation date. [Erasmus University Rotterdam](#)

How to apply:

You apply directly at the IND — not through your university. You must wait until you have received your degree certificate or have your faculty fill out the IND's completion of study form before applying. [University of Amsterdam](#)

After finding a job, you can convert to a **Highly Skilled Migrant** (*kennismigrant*) work permit.

10. Official Information

Resource	Link
IND (Immigration & Naturalisation Service)	https://ind.nl/en
Dutch Government Immigration Portal	https://government.nl
Netherlands Worldwide (Embassy Info)	https://netherlandsworldwide.nl
Study in NL (official portal)	https://studyinnl.org
Nuffic (education recognition)	https://nuffic.nl/en
IAmsterdam (expat guide)	https://iamsterdam.com

11. Application Forms

- **MVV + VVR (TEV procedure):** Submitted by your university to the IND — no separate download needed; your international office will guide you
- **Orientation Year Permit:** Apply directly at <https://ind.nl/en/residence-permits/work/residence-permit-for-orientation-year>
- **BRP registration (municipality):** Done in person at your local *gemeente* (city hall)
- **IND general forms and checklists:** <https://ind.nl/en/forms>

12. Tips for Students — Common Mistakes to Avoid

Mistake	How to Avoid It
Contacting the IND directly instead of your university	Your university submits your visa application — go to the international office first
Choosing the wrong embassy for MVV collection	Once the application has been submitted, the chosen embassy cannot be changed Utrecht University — choose carefully

Failing to register with the municipality (BRP)	Register within 5 days of arrival at your local <i>gemeente</i>
Poor academic progress	You must complete at least 50% of required academic credits annually Visasupdate or risk losing your permit
Missing the orientation year deadline	You must apply within 3 years of your graduation date Erasmus University Rotterdam
Not checking if you need an MVV or only a VVR	Citizens of some countries (e.g. USA, UK, Australia) only need a VVR — check with your university
Waiting too long to start the process	Deadlines for September intake are June 15th, and for February intake November 15th Utrecht University — start months in advance
Underestimating financial requirements	You need to show €12,000/year — prepare clear, official bank statements

Important: The Netherlands immigration system is largely **university-driven**. Your first point of contact for all visa and permit matters should always be your **university's international student office**, not the IND or embassy directly.

Gemini

1. Study Courses

To qualify for a Dutch study residence permit, you must be enrolled as a full-time student in an accredited program at a **recognized sponsor** institution (universities and colleges officially approved by the IND). These include:

- Bachelor's and Master's degree programs at research universities (*WO*) or universities of applied sciences (*HBO*).
- Doctoral (PhD) programs.
- Specific, authorized preparatory vocational programs or short-term higher education courses.

2. Embassy Appointment

The visa application process for the Netherlands is unique because **your university acts as your sponsor and handles the application first**.

- You cannot apply directly to the Dutch Immigration and Naturalisation Service (**IND**) yourself; your university will initiate the online process on your behalf once you are admitted.

- After the IND approves the application, you will receive instructions to book an appointment at the Dutch embassy or consulate in your home country (or via partner centers like VFS Global) to collect your **MVV (entry visa sticker)**.

3. Applying for a Study Visa

- **What documents are needed:** A valid passport, the university's official offer letter, proof of financial sufficiency (the "study norm"), and a completed antecedents certificate (criminal history declaration).
- **How to apply:** 1. Accept your university offer and submit your required digital documents directly to the university's international office.

2. The university reviews your files, collects the visa fees, and submits the official application directly to the IND.

3. Once approved, you visit your local Dutch embassy to provide fingerprints and get the MVV sticker in your passport.

- **How long it usually takes:** The IND usually **processes university-led applications within 2 to 4 weeks**. However, you should start the process with **your university 3 months** before your courses begin to allow time for document collection and embassy appointments.

Gemini's "2–4 weeks" is acceptable but doesn't account for 8-week total timeline .

4. Documents Needed

Your university will request digital copies, and you must bring the originals to the embassy:

- A valid passport with at least two blank pages.
- Official **Admission Letter** from the recognized Dutch institution.
- **Proof of sufficient financial means** (bank statements or deposit receipts).
- Completed and signed **Antecedents Certificate** (a declaration showing you do not have a criminal record).
- Legalized and translated birth certificate (often required for local municipal registration upon arrival, rather than the visa itself).
- Proof of private healthcare insurance (e.g., Aon Student Insurance) covering your first few months.

5. Money Requirements

The IND enforces a strict baseline living allowance threshold known as the **Study Norm** (*studienorm*). This covers living costs only; tuition fees must be calculated and paid separately.

- The required study norm is **€1,130.77 per month**, which equates to **€13,569.24 for a full academic year**.

You can prove you hold these funds via:

- **The University Deposit Method (Most Common & Preferred):** You transfer your full year's tuition plus the €13,569.24 living allowance directly into the university's secure bank account. They hold it and refund the living allowance back to your local Dutch bank account after you arrive.
- **Personal Bank Account:** Submitting bank statements (not older than 3 months) showing the full sum in a completely un-locked, freely withdrawable account in your name.
- **Official Scholarship:** A formal letter showing a grant that meets or exceeds the monthly study norm.

6. Residence Permit

The entry visa (MVV) is only a temporary sticker used to cross the border.

- Within your first two weeks in the Netherlands, you will pick up your physical **Residence Permit Card** (*Verblijfsvergunning*) from a designated IND desk or a special university collection day.
- You are also legally required to register with the local town hall (**Gemeente**) of the city where you reside to obtain your Citizen Service Number (**BSN**—*Burgerservicenummer*).

7. Working While Studying

Non-EU students can work alongside their studies, but the rules are heavily monitored:

- **Hour Limits:** You must strictly choose between working up to **16 hours per week during the academic year**, **OR working full-time (40 hours per week) only during the summer months** (June, July, and August). You cannot do both.
- **Work Permit Required:** Your employer must apply for a specific, free work permit called a **TWV** (*Tewerkstellingsvergunning*) from the Dutch labor agency (UWV) before you can work. This process takes around 5 weeks.
- **Self-Employment Expiration:** Alternatively, non-EU students can work unlimited hours as a freelancer (**ZZP**), provided they register with the Chamber of Commerce (*KVK*) and maintain their university grades.
- *Note: If you take a side job or a paid internship, you are legally required to switch from student insurance to Dutch public health insurance (basisverzekering).*

Correctly notes the TWV requirement and employer application process.

8. Renewing the Residence Permit

Your student residence permit is usually issued for the entire duration of your degree plus an extra 3 months. However, you must maintain **satisfactory academic progress**:

- Under Dutch law (the MoH covenant), you must pass at least **50% of your required European credits (ECTS)** each academic year to keep your permit.
- If you lag behind without a valid medical or personal excuse, the university is legally required to report you to the IND, which will revoke your residence permit.

9. Changing to a Work Permit

Upon completing a Bachelor's, Master's, or PhD program in the Netherlands:

- You can apply online via the IND for an **Orientation Year Permit (Zoekjaar)**. This grants you 12 months of unrestricted access to the Dutch labor market to find a job. Your employer does not need a work permit for you during this year.
- Once you secure a job during this year, you can seamlessly transition into a **Highly Skilled Migrant (Kennismigrant)** visa, provided the job pays a specific lower income threshold reserved for recent Dutch graduates.

10. Official Information

- Main immigration tracking, updates, and rules: [IND \(Immigration and Naturalisation Service\)](#)
- General system frameworks and student support: [Study in NL / Nuffic](#)
- Work permit and employment tracking: [UWV \(Employee Insurance Agency\)](#)

11. Application Forms

Because Dutch universities manage the immigration portal directly with the IND, you do not need to download or fill out raw paper visa forms. Your university will email you a secure link to their institutional intake portal where you upload your scans. The only physical forms you might print and hand-sign are standard annexes (like the **Antecedents Certificate** or **Tuberculosis Test Intent Form**), which are provided directly within the university portal or downloadable via the IND website.

12. Tips for Students (Common Mistakes to Avoid)

- **Working Without a TWV:** Do not start a job (even a single training shift) before your employer's TWV application is formally approved. Working without it triggers an automatic multi-thousand-euro fine for the employer and risks immediate deportation or permit cancellation for you.
- **The "Locked Account" Mistake:** If you choose to prove your funds via your own bank account rather than depositing it to the school, the funds cannot be in a fixed-term deposit or investment fund. The cash must be immediately accessible.

- **Missing the 50% Credit Rule:** Treat your studies seriously. Falling below the 50% ECTS threshold without reporting mitigating circumstances to a student counselor early in the year is one of the most common reasons student permits get revoked.

Netherlands: AI Error Report

1. Study Courses

Claude: Lists full-time Bachelor's, Master's, PhD, exchange programmes, and preparatory/foundation courses linked to a recognised university. **Correct.**

Gemini: Lists Bachelor's and Master's at research universities (WO) or universities of applied sciences (HBO), PhD programs, and specific preparatory vocational programs. **Correct.**

Both: Correct. Eligible programs are full-time at recognized sponsor institutions.

2. Embassy Appointment

Claude: Explains the university-led system—university submits application to IND; student chooses embassy for MVV pickup; embassy cannot be changed after submission. **Correct.**

Gemini: Similar: university initiates process; after IND approval, student books embassy appointment for MVV sticker. **Correct.**

Both: Correct. The university acts as the recognized sponsor and submits the TEV application . Students cannot apply directly .

3. Applying for a Study Visa (Processing Time)

Claude: States IND target decision period is 2 weeks; legal period is 60 days; in summer can take up to 3 weeks. **Partially correct.**

Gemini: States processing takes 2–4 weeks; recommends starting 3 months before. **Partially correct.**

Correct Answer:

- IND processing normally takes about **2–4 weeks** after application
- Some universities state **approximately 8 weeks (about 2 months)** total
- In practice, MVV may be issued at the embassy **2–6 weeks** after submission
- The legal decision period is **60 days**
- Universities can only apply **3 months before** the program start date

Error: Claude's "3 weeks" is too optimistic—while possible, 2–4 weeks is standard . Gemini's "2–4 weeks" is acceptable but doesn't account for 8-week total timeline .

4. Documents Needed

Claude: Lists passport (12 months validity), admission letter, financial proof, health insurance, transcripts, photos, language tests. **Partial error on passport validity.**

Gemini: Lists passport (two blank pages), admission letter, financial proof, antecedents certificate, birth certificate, health insurance. **Correct.**

Correct Answer:

Official university checklists include:

Document	Requirement
Passport	Valid for at least 18 months after arrival, preferably entire study period ; some sources say 6 months after MVV
Passport photos	Must comply with strict Dutch photo requirements

Admission letter	Official offer from Dutch institution
Proof of financial means	Bank transfer to university or bank statement
Antecedents Certificate	Declaration of no criminal record (provided by university portal)
Birth certificate	Often required for municipal registration, not always for visa
Health insurance	Must cover the Netherlands; universities arrange Aon insurance (~€692/year)

Error: Claude's passport validity is **incorrect**—the requirement is at least **18 months**, not 12 . Gemini correctly requires the Antecedents Certificate and notes birth certificate is for registration .

5. Money Requirements (Financial Means / Study Norm)

Claude: States €12,000/year (approx. €870/month). **Incorrect.**

Gemini: States €1,130.77/month = €13,569.24/year. **Correct.**

Correct Answer (2026):

Amount	Source
Monthly study norm	€1,130.77/month
Annual living expenses	€13,569.24
Alternative amounts	Some universities: €13,200 (€1,100/month) ; TU/e: €13,600 ; Leiden:

€13,800 ; Gerrit Rietveld: €1,130.70/month
= €13,568.40

Total package fee

Tuition + living expenses + fees + insurance
= approx. €24,500–€27,600 depending on
university and program

Methods to prove funds :

- **Method 1 (bank transfer to university):** Most common; university holds funds and refunds after arrival
- **Method 2 (bank statement):** Personal bank statement in student's name showing full amount
- **Scholarship:** Scholarship letter covering tuition + living expenses

Error: Claude is significantly **incorrect**—€12,000 is the **old** amount or close but under the correct 2026 figure of €13,569.24 . Gemini is **correct** on the main amount.

6. Residence Permit

Claude: States MVV collected at embassy; VVR residence permit card collected at IND desk after arrival; BRP registration within 5 days. **Correct.**

Gemini: States residence permit card picked up at IND desk within first two weeks; BRP registration with gemeente for BSN. **Correct.**

Both: Correct. Official sources confirm:

- MVV is collected at the embassy before travel
- VVR residence permit card is collected after arrival at IND desk or university collection day
- Municipal registration (BRP) is mandatory

7. Working While Studying

Claude: States 16 hours/week during academic year and full-time during summer; STEM students can work 24 hours/week from 2025. **Partially correct.**

Gemini: States must choose between 16 hours/week during term OR full-time only in summer (June–August); employer must apply for TWV work permit; self-employment possible. **Partially correct.**

Correct Answer:

- Non-EU students can work **16 hours/week** during the academic year **OR** full-time during the summer (June–August)
- **Work permit required:** Employer must apply for a **TWV** (Tewerkstellingsvergunning) from UWV
- **Processing time:** UWV can take up to **5 weeks** to approve the permit
- **One employer:** TWV is valid for **one employer only**—students need separate permits for each job
- The residence permit itself does **not** grant work rights; work is only allowed with a TWV
- Working without a TWV is illegal and can lead to permit revocation
- Students **do not** apply for the TWV themselves—the employer applies

Errors:

- **Claude:** States "No additional work permit is needed"—this is **incorrect**. A TWV work permit is always required .
- **Claude:** STEM 24-hour rule—this is **not confirmed** in official sources and appears to be misinformation.
- **Gemini:** Correctly notes the TWV requirement and employer application process.

8. Renewing the Residence Permit

Claude: States university manages renewal; 50% of credits required annually; fee €254. **Correct.**

Gemini: States 50% ECTS credit rule; university must report failure to IND; permit revoked if below threshold. **Correct.**

Both: Correct. Official sources confirm:

- Students must obtain at least **50% of credits (30 ECTS out of 60)** each academic year
- Exceptions only for proven exceptional circumstances (illness, family circumstances, pregnancy, etc.)
- Universities must report failure to IND, leading to permit cancellation
- Students must maintain sufficient financial means each year

9. Changing to a Work Permit (Orientation Year / Zoekjaar)

Claude: States Orientation Year Permit allows up to 12 months; apply within 3 years of graduation; free access to labor market; convert to Highly Skilled Migrant. **Correct.**

Gemini: States Orientation Year Permit (Zoekjaar) for 12 months with unrestricted labor market access; transition to Highly Skilled Migrant with lower salary threshold. **Correct.**

Both: Correct. The orientation year permit is a key feature of the Dutch immigration system.

10. Official Information

Claude: Lists IND, Dutch Government Portal, Netherlands Worldwide, Study in NL, Nuffic, IAmsterdam. **Correct.**

Gemini: Lists IND, Study in NL/Nuffic, UWV. **Correct.**

Both: Correct. All official sources verified.

11. Application Forms

Claude: States university submits TEV application; no separate download; Orientation Year via IND; BRP registration in person. **Correct.**

Gemini: States university manages portal; no paper forms needed; Antecedents Certificate provided via university portal. **Correct.**

Both: Correct.

12. Tips for Students

Claude: Lists: contact university first (not IND); choose embassy carefully; BRP within 5 days; 50% credit rule; orientation year deadline; check MVV exemption; deadlines (1 June for September); financial requirements. **Correct.**

Gemini: Lists: TWV required before working; university deposit method is preferred; 50% credit rule; don't start work without TWV. **Correct.**

Errors:

- **Claude:** "No additional work permit is needed" is **incorrect**—a TWV is required
- **Claude:** "STEM students can work up to 24 hours/week" is **not confirmed**—this is unreliable information
- **Both:** Neither sufficiently emphasizes that the **employer must apply for the TWV** and it takes up to 5 weeks

Summary Comparison

Topic	Claude	Gemini	Correct Answer
Study Courses	Correct	Correct	Full-time programs at recognized sponsor institutions
Passport Validity	12 months	Two blank pages	18 months after arrival

Processing Time	2–3 weeks	2–4 weeks	2–4 weeks ; total up to 8 weeks
Financial Means (2026)	€12,000/year	€13,569.24/year	€13,569.24/year (€1,130.77/month)
Work Rules	No TWV needed	TWV required	TWV required —employer applies, up to 5 weeks
Work Hours	16 hours/week	16 hrs OR full-time summer	16 hrs/week term OR full-time summer (June–Aug)
Work Permit Processing	Not specified	~5 weeks	UWV takes up to 5 weeks for TWV
Credit Requirement	50% (30/60 ECTS)	50% (30/60 ECTS)	Must obtain 50% of credits annually
Renewal Fee	€254	Not specified	€254
Orientation Year	12 months	12 months	12-month Zoekjaar permit

Critical Fixes

Topic	Wrong	Correct
Passport validity (Claude)	12 months	18 months after arrival
Financial means (Claude)	€12,000/year	€13,569.24/year (2026)

Work permit (Claude)	"No separate work permit needed"	TWV required from UWV —employer applies
STEM 24-hour rule (Claude)	24 hours/week	Not confirmed —unreliable source
Work permit processing (Gemini)	Not specified	Up to 5 weeks for UWV approval
TWV one employer rule	Not mentioned	TWV valid for one employer only —multiple jobs need multiple TWVs
Financial proof methods	Not detailed	University deposit preferred ; bank statements accepted for some nationalities
Birth certificate	Not specified	Required for municipal registration , not always for visa